Capture the Flag Tournament Rules & Scoring System

Tournament Format

- Participants are divided into six teams, with two teams representing each college.
- Games are played in 20-minute rounds with a 5-minute transition period between rounds.
- *Approximately 150 participants are on the field at a time.*
- At the conclusion of all rounds, scores are combined to determine the overall college champion.

Objective	Team Roles
Collect cones from the opposing team's territory and safely return them to your Home Base to earn points.	Runner: Collects cones and attempts flag captures by entering opposing territory and returning safely.
Capture the opposing team's flag once all opposing cones have been collected.	Defender: Protects the team's cones, flag, and territory from opposing players.
Defend your team's cones, flag, and teammates from opposing players.	Tagger: Focuses on tagging opposing players and sending them to Jail.
Work together to earn the highest score possible during each round.	Jail Breaker: Frees teammates from Jail and supports offensive pushes into enemy territory.
Help your college accumulate points toward the overall tournament championship.	Flexible Player: Moves between offense and defense depending on the team's needs throughout the round.

Starting the Round

- All participants begin at their Home Base.
- No participant may cross into opposing territory until the starting whistle.
- ELs and Execs will provide final instructions before gameplay begins.

Tagging Rules

- Players are tagged when an opponent removes the flag tucked into their belt.
- No pushing, grabbing, tackling, body-checking, or aggressive physical contact is permitted.
- Dangerous or unsportsmanlike behavior may result in removal from the round.
- Executive decisions are final.

Jail Rules

- Tagged participants must immediately proceed to their designated Jail.
- Tagged participants may not continue gameplay until freed.
- A teammate may free a jailed participant by entering the Jail zone and tagging them.

- Freed participants receive a brief immunity period while leaving the Jail area and re-receive their flags.

Cone Scoring System

- Each team starts with 10-20 cones positioned around their flag.
- Each cone is worth 1 point.
- Participants may only carry one cone at a time.
- To score, a participant must:
    - Enter enemy territory.
    - Collect a cone.
    - Return safely to Home Base.
    - Hand the cone to the designated scorekeeper.
    - If a participant carrying a cone is tagged, the cone does not count and is left on the floor where the participant is tagged.

Flag Capture Rules

- A team may not attempt to capture the opposing flag until all opposing cones have been collected.
- To successfully capture a flag, a participant must:
- Enter enemy territory.
- Retrieve the enemy flag.
- Return the flag safely to Home Base without being tagged.
- The flag is worth the same number of points as the total cones originally defending it.
- Examples
    - 10 defending cones = 10-point flag
    - 15 defending cones = 15-point flag
    - 20 defending cones = 20-point flag

Tagged While Carrying the Flag

- If a participant carrying a flag is tagged:
- The flag is immediately returned to its original location.
- The participant proceeds to Jail.
- The team must restart their flag capture attempt.

Final Five Minutes

- When five minutes remain in the round:
    - Cone Removal: All remaining cones are removed from gameplay. No additional cone points may be earned.

    - Prison Break: A Prison Break will be announced by event staff. All jailed participants are immediately released.
    - The final five minutes focus entirely on flag captures.

Sportsmanship Expectations

- Participants are expected to:
    - Respect all players, leaders, and staff.
    - Follow instructions from ELs and Executives.
    - Play honestly and safely.
    - Demonstrate good sportsmanship at all times.
    - Include and encourage teammates.
- Participants may be removed from gameplay for:
    - Dangerous conduct.
    - Repeated rule violations.
    - Aggressive behavior.
    - Harassment or intimidation of others.

Determining the Winner

- Final Score = Cone Points + Flag Points
- Example:
    - 14 cones collected = 14 points
    - One 15-point flag captured = 15 points
    - Final Score = 29 points

At the conclusion of the tournament, the college with the highest cumulative score across all rounds will be awarded the Capture the Flag Championship Trophy.